

Himalayas



Cheran Senguttuvan

This can be understood from the epic Silappathikaram written by Senguttuvan's brother Ilangovadigal. "Pathitrupathu" helps to know about the Chera kings during Sangam period.

**Cheras :**

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|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1. River | - | Poigai | 2. Capital | - | Vanji |
| 3. Port | - | Thondi, Musiri | 4. Symbol | - | Bow and Arrow |

**Try to answer**

- ❖ Who were the greatest kings of early Cheras?
- ❖ Name the epic written by Ilangovadigal.

## Cholas

The early Cholas kept Uraiyur as their capital located along the river Cauvery and ruled it. Uruthirangkannanar of Kadiyalur in his Pattinappalai describes that Cholanadu is famous for rice (Cholanadu Sorudaithu).

The Chola kingdom comprised the districts of Trichirapalli, Tanjavur, Pudukkottai, Nagapattinam, Tiruvarur, Mayiladuthurai, Perambalur, Ariyalur and Cuddalore.

The land of Cholas was fertile due to the river Cauvery. The kings ruled by providing justice to their subjects. The greatest ruler among the Cholas was Karikala Cholan who was also called 'Karikala Peruvalathan'.

Karikala Cholan took the responsibility of kingship at a very early age and ruled efficiently. It is said that, when he was very young, he was captured by his enemies and imprisoned. The room in which he was arrested was set on fire. In this fire accident, his feet burnt. Due to his charred leg, he was called as 'Karikalan'.

At a very young age he disguised as an old man and tactfully justified a case.